

Solution: MomentSort Lets the System Group the Flood

3 SOLUTIONS EVALUATED AGAINST THE 1,000-PHOTO FLOOD, ONE CHOSEN

Solution

Not chosen

1 Dimension Cut

Step-by-step question filtering

Problem: 79% find no way to narrow results once they land. Groups by year, people and place exist, but the system never asks about them.

- 1 Results return; filters appear
- 2 AI finds categories inside them
- 3 User picks a filter first: People, Year, Location or Event
- 4 Picks 2023 → 1,000 becomes 300
- 5 Picks Beach → 300 becomes 80
- 6 Repeats until small enough to scan

Why not chosen: user must decide which filter to apply first, a hard call when already overwhelmed. The flood shrinks but the load stays.

✗ User still has to decide first

CHOSEN

2 Moment Sort

Clustered results the user just taps

Problem: 32% are overwhelmed by 1,000 similar photos with no way through, and 79% say nothing in Google Photos helps narrow results today. The search worked; the gap is in the results.

- 1 Search returns the flood of results as normal
- 2 System auto-groups: trip, time, people, place
- 3 Groups appear as labelled chips above results
- 4 User looks at the chips and taps the one that matches their memory
- 5 Results narrow to just that group
- 6 No typing, no decisions: just recognise, tap

Why chosen: the system does all the grouping work. The user only recognises: no deciding, typing or thinking, on any size result set. Zero added effort when most frustrated.

✓ System does the hard work

Not chosen

3 Anchor Sort

Pick one photo, system re-orders

Problem: 52% are overwhelmed by results that all look alike. The photo they want is among 1,000, but every thumbnail looks too similar.

- 1 User taps one 'closest to mine'
- 2 System uses it as the reference
- 3 Remaining photos re-order by how visually similar they are to it
- 4 Most similar photos move to top
- 5 User scans a sorted list, no pile
- 6 Target photo rises toward the top

Why not chosen: the user must first find a 'close enough' photo inside the same flood. With 1,000 look-alikes there is no obvious pick to make.

✗ User must find a photo first

MomentSort is the only mechanism where the system does the hard work.

DimensionCut still makes the user decide what to filter by first. AnchorSort asks the user to find a photo inside the flood.